



THE SILENT ALARM

HOMICIDE · 2020

CASE NUMBER	23-0121
INVESTIGATING TEAM	The Night Shift
PRINTED	2026-09-26

RESTRICTED



BRIEFING

THE INCIDENT

At 08:30 on Sunday 15 March 2020 the monitoring company for 123 Oak Lane, Willow Creek, received a silent alarm from the property. Patrol officers attended at 08:41 and found the front door standing slightly ajar. Richard Henderson was found dead in the home office on the ground floor.

THE DECEASED

Richard Henderson, 45, founder of Henderson Tech, a Willow Creek software company. Lived alone. Described by colleagues as meticulous, exacting and rarely out of the office before midnight. The last message from his account is an email sent at about 01:45 saying he was still working.

THE SCENE AS FOUND

Henderson was slumped over his desk with a single gunshot wound to the head. A handgun lay on the carpet beside the chair and the top desk drawer was open. There was no sign of forced entry and no disturbance in the rest of the house. His smartphone and computer equipment have been seized for analysis.

WHAT IS ESTABLISHED

The alarm was triggered at 08:30. A neighbour reports a loud noise at around 02:30 and did not go to look. Nothing of obvious value was taken from the house.

LINES OF ENQUIRY

Whether this death is what it appears to be. Who had access to the house, and how they came in without forcing a door. Henderson's last working hours: his email, his calendar and the state of his business.

ACTIONS OUTSTANDING

Search the house room by room. Canvass Oak Lane for doorbell and CCTV footage. Interview the business partner, the assistant, the principal investor, the household staff and the neighbours. Submit recovered exhibits to the laboratory.

OFFICER IN THE CASE

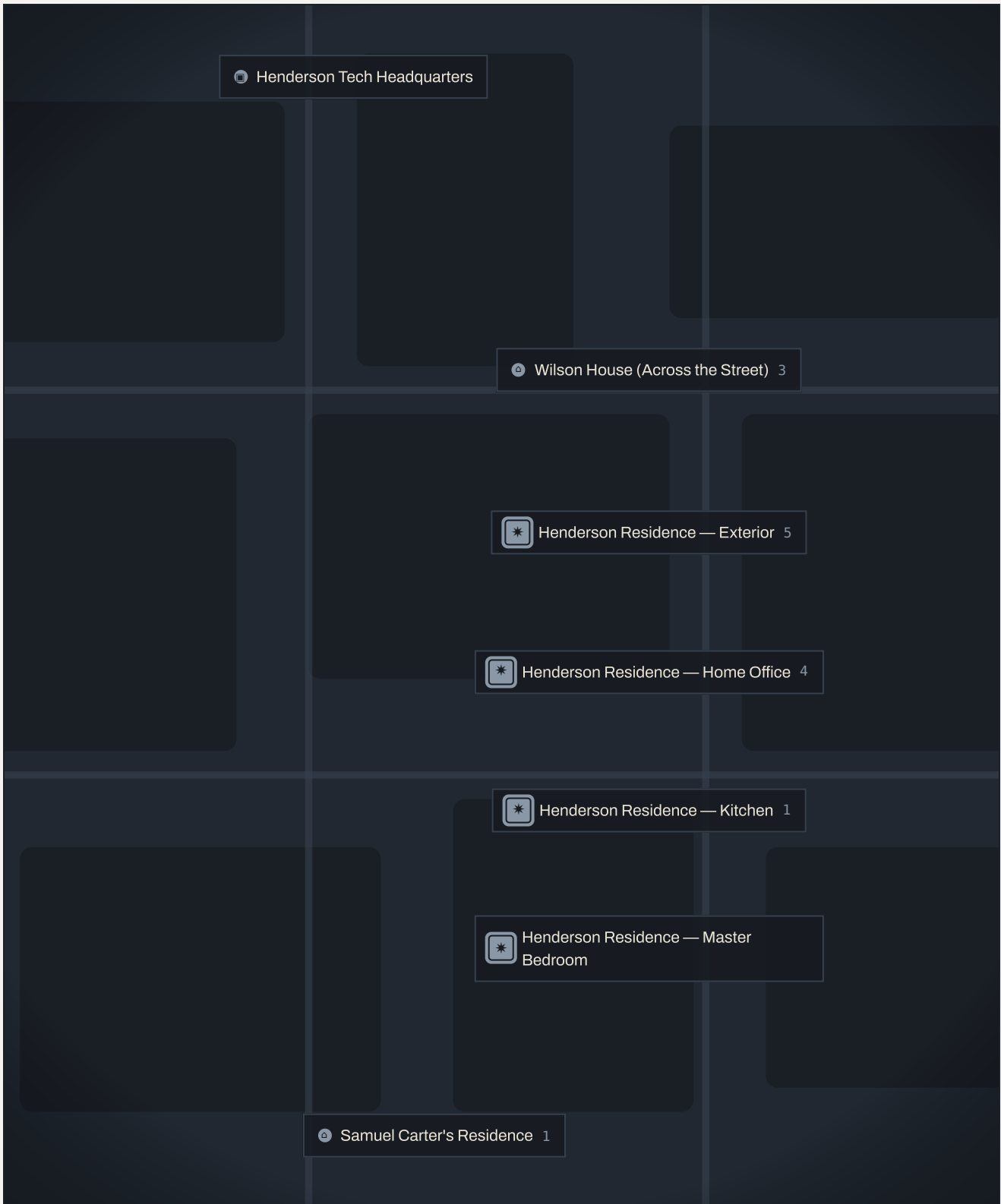
Willow Creek CID, Major Crimes. The team reports at the close of each investigation day.

OBJECTIVES

- 01 Determine the cause of death and gather forensic evidence from the scene.
- 02 Interview neighbors and witnesses to establish a timeline of events.
- 03 Establish who, if anyone, was in the house that night, and how they got in.



AREA MAP





HENDERSON RESIDENCE — EXTERIOR



ADDRESS	123 Oak Lane, Willow Creek
CLASSIFICATION	Crime scene

DESCRIPTION

High-end residential property with a well-manicured lawn and a two-car garage. The front door was found slightly ajar.



HENDERSON TECH HEADQUARTERS



ADDRESS	789 Business Avenue, Willow Creek
CLASSIFICATION	Business

DESCRIPTION

Modern office building housing Henderson Tech's main offices.



FIBRE ON OFFICE CHAIR



E-03

A single dark-green fibre recovered from the seat of the office chair.

CLASSIFICATION	Trace
RECOVERED FROM	Henderson Residence — Home Office
RECOVERED	2020-03-15 10:00
COLLECTED BY	Detective Sarah Kowalski

CHAIN OF CUSTODY

DATE AND TIME	ACTION	SIGNED
2020-03-15 10:15	Collected and sealed the evidence.	Detective Sarah Kowalski
2020-03-15 11:00	Transferred to forensic laboratory for analysis.	Crime Scene Technician Mike Durant

EXHIBITS OFFICER

Detective Sergeant N. Quill

DATE



DNA SWAB, OFFICE DOOR HANDLE



E-04

Swab taken from the inner handle of the home-office door, sealed with its submission form.

CLASSIFICATION	Biological
RECOVERED FROM	Henderson Residence — Home Office
RECOVERED	2020-03-15 10:30
COLLECTED BY	Detective Sarah Kowalski

CHAIN OF CUSTODY

DATE AND TIME	ACTION	SIGNED
2020-03-15 10:45	Collected and sealed the evidence.	Detective Sarah Kowalski
2020-03-15 11:30	Transferred to forensic laboratory for analysis.	Crime Scene Technician Mike Durant

EXHIBITS OFFICER

Detective Sergeant N. Quill

DATE



DOORBELL CAMERA FOOTAGE



E-08

Recording from the doorbell camera at 124 Oak Lane, which faces the Henderson driveway, for 14–15 March.

CLASSIFICATION	Digital
RECOVERED FROM	Wilson House (Across the Street)
RECOVERED	2020-03-16 15:30
COLLECTED BY	Detective Sarah Kowalski

CHAIN OF CUSTODY

DATE AND TIME	ACTION	SIGNED
2020-03-16 15:45	Collected and sealed the evidence.	Detective Sarah Kowalski
2020-03-16 16:30	Transferred to digital forensics laboratory for analysis.	Digital Forensics Examiner Lena Ortiz

EXHIBITS OFFICER

Detective Sergeant N. Quill

DATE



DIGITAL ANALYSIS

ITEM SUBMITTED	E-08 — Doorbell Camera Footage
METHOD	Digital
CONFIDENCE	High

CONCLUSION

A marked delivery van stops at 18:04 on 14 March. A courier in a company cap carries one parcel to the side door and leaves at 18:07. After 21:10 the camera's night mode no longer resolves the driveway.

EXAMINATION

Footage from the doorbell camera at 124 Oak Lane, facing the Henderson driveway, was recovered for 14–15 March 2020 and reviewed frame by frame for arrivals and departures.

REPORTING EXAMINER

P. Ineson

DATE



FIBRE ANALYSIS

ITEM SUBMITTED	E-03 — Fibre on Office Chair
METHOD	Fibre
CONFIDENCE	High

CONCLUSION

The fibre is consistent with common household carpet and upholstery dust. It does not identify any individual.

EXAMINATION

A single fibre recovered from the office chair was examined under comparison microscopy against reference samples.

REPORTING EXAMINER

P. Ineson

DATE